likes to be told that? The first key is always keeping an open mind. Remember that we're all human, no one is perfect, and we always have the capacity to improve. When things aren't perfect (and are they ever?), then you have an opportunity to make them better.

When you're presenting trends that you want to improve on, ensure that you're keeping a positive spin on things. Focus on the positive that will come from the change, not the negative that you're trying to avoid. Always strive to be better instead of running away from the bad.

Always steer away from blame or finger pointing. Data is a great tool when used for good, but many people fear measurement because it can also be misunderstood. An easy example of this would be measuring lines of code (LOC) written by your development team. LOC doesn't always point to how much work a developer is getting done. Something that has a lot of boilerplate code that gets autogenerated by a tool may have a very high LOC; an extremely complex algorithm that takes a while to tune may have a very low LOC. Most developers will tell you the lower LOC is much better in this case (unless you're talking to the developer who wrote the code generator for the former). It's always important to look at trends and understand that all the data you collect is part of a larger picture that most likely the team in the trenches will understand the best. Providing context and staying flexible when interpreting results is an important part of ensuring successful adoption of change. Don't freak out if your productivity drops on every Wednesday; maybe there's some good reason for that. The important thing is that everyone is aware of what's happening, what you're focused on improving, and how you're measuring the change you want to see.

1.6. Taking ownership and measuring your team

Development teams should be responsible for tracking themselves through metrics that are easy to obtain and communicate. Agile frameworks have natural pauses to allow your team to check and adjust. At this point you should have an idea of the good and bad of how you approach and do your work. Now, take the bull by the horns and start measuring!